FOR PARENTS · SUPPORTING YOUR YOUNG PLAYER

COMPARISON & SOCIAL MEDIA

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Their only competition is who they were yesterday

THE QUICK VERSION

> It's natural for kids to compare themselves to teammates, siblings or players online. But constant comparison can quietly drain their confidence and enjoyment. Helping your child focus on their own progress, and see social media for what it is, keeps their love of the game safe.

WHAT'S REALLY GOING ON

Social media shows highlight reels: perfect skills, perfect bodies, perfect lives. Young players can start to feel they're falling behind, even when they're doing really well. Comparing to teammates can also turn friends into rivals. Kids develop at very different rates, and early talent is not the same as long-term success.

SIGNS COMPARISON IS BECOMING A PROBLEM

"EVERYONE'S BETTER THAN ME"

Regularly putting themselves down compared to others.

SCROLLING AFTER GAMES

Spending a lot of time watching other players online, then feeling worse.

JEALOUSY OF TEAMMATES

Struggling to celebrate when friends do well.

LOSING ENJOYMENT

Focusing more on rankings and followers than on playing.

Highlight reels aren't real life

Even professional players post only their best moments. Help your child understand that every clip online hides hours of practice, mistakes and bad days that nobody films.

TRY THIS

1 Compare to their past self
"Look how much your left foot has improved since last season."

2 Talk about what they watch
Ask which accounts make them feel inspired and which make them feel worse.

3 Set some screen boundaries
No phones straight after games, and none in the bedroom at night.

4 Celebrate teammates together
Show them how to be genuinely happy when others do well.

5 Remind them about timing
Kids grow and develop at different ages. Late bloomers often catch up and pass early stars.

SAY THIS, NOT THAT

SAY THIS	NOT THAT
"You've improved so much this year."	~~"Why can't you be more like her?"~~
"Everyone develops at their own pace."	~~"She's much better than you."~~
"Remember, online clips are only highlights."	~~"You need more followers to get noticed."~~

QUICK SELF-CHECK

- [ ] I avoid comparing my child to others
- [ ] We talk about what they see online
- [ ] We have some screen-free times
- [ ] I celebrate their personal progress

Can't tick them all yet? That's normal. Pick one to work on this week.

COACH'S CORNER

"Plenty of great players were late bloomers. The ones who made it focused on their own journey, not everyone else's highlights."

THE FUTURE BALLER TEAM